



Final Project

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Deadline: Friday 19 June 2026, 17:00

The final project is **group work** (groups of 4 students). Groups self-organise — aim for a mix of capabilities. The same groups are used for both the debate and the final report.

The project aims to develop a **global climate mitigation strategy** from the perspective of your self-assigned actor. Each group adopts a specific role and designs a strategy in line with their assigned actor, but in light of the multi-actor complexity of the case. As part of the project, there are two structured debates (see [Debate](#)).

Report structure

The final report has **two parts**:

Part	Title	Weight
1	Model-based analysis and policy advice	70 %
2	Political reflection on the climate change debate	30 %

Maximum length: 10,000 words for the main text (excluding references and appendices). Figures and tables count as 300 words each. Being over the word limit can result in a lower grade.

Style: Written for a technically-minded audience. Bottom line up front (BLUF). Aim for 10–20 pages.

Part 1 — Model-based analysis and policy advice (70 %)

Goal

Show that you can structure a messy decision problem, analyse it using carefully selected DMDU techniques, and render advice to policy makers.

Suggested outline

Executive summary (*1 page*) Advice for the problem owner — understandable for a general audience unfamiliar with deep uncertainty methods. What advice do you give, and why?

Problem framing The decision problem can be structured in many ways. How are you framing it? What do you see as the key objectives and constraints? What levers are relevant? What is treated as uncertain? Show awareness of the political arena your problem owner operates in. You may entertain more than one problem formulation.

Approach What selection of deep uncertainty methods are you using, in what order, and why? Clearly motivate and ground in the literature.

Results A readable summary of results. Don't pursue death by figures — carefully select visualisations that tell your story and logically lead to the conclusions and policy advice.

Discussion What are the key threats to the validity of your conclusions? What directions do you see for further refinement? Ground in literature and awareness of the decision arena.

Conclusions Extended conclusion grounded in your results and discussion, leading to clear advice for your problem owner.

Code and analyses

The code and analyses are an integral part of the assignment. The **primary focus of grading is on reproducibility**.

Checklist:

- Is there a README explaining dependencies and repository structure?
- Are the datasets required to reproduce the advice included?
- Can all figures and tables in the report be traced to specific notebooks?
- Is the code annotated and are results interpreted?
- Is the analysis process tractable from the notebooks/scripts?
- Does the code follow [PEP 8](#) and the [NumPy doc standard](#)?

Use **literate computing** in Jupyter notebooks: interleave code, outputs, text, and LaTeX equations so someone else can follow your thinking.

Submit code as either a GitHub repository link or a zip file shared via a file transfer service.

Rubric — Part 1

Criterion	Insufficient	Weak	Sufficient	Good	Excellent
Executive summary	No advice	Unclear or inaccessible advice	Clear advice understandable to non-expert	Clear, grounded in multi-actor context	Convincing advice for non-expert actor under uncertainty
Problem framing	No clear framing	Naïve framing, no awareness of policy arena	Sensible framing in light of problem owner	Attention to multiple key actors	Explicit framing of multiple perspectives
Approach	Single technique, no literature	Limited techniques, poorly grounded	Standard DMDU approach (e.g. RDM), grounded in literature	Multiple framings or state-of-the-art techniques, motivated	Analysis of rival framings using the-a
Results	Death by graphs, no narrative	Too many graphs, limited story	Readable story with well-chosen visuals	Carefully designed visuals supporting narrative	Convincing story carefully designed visual
Discussion	No awareness of limitations	Mentions limitations without implications	Identifies key limitations and their implications	Methodological + policy arena limitations discussed	Limited discussion of future suggestions
Conclusions	Inconsistent, not linked to problem owner	Trivial conclusions	Consistent conclusions, appropriate advice	Advice appropriate for problem owner and multi-actor context	Convincing conclusion with appropriate multi-actor context

Part 2 — Political reflection on the climate change

debate (30 %)

Goal

Show your understanding of the different roles that (model-based) knowledge plays in decision making, drawing on the concrete negotiations of the climate change debate.

What to write

Analyse the different ways in which knowledge was used in the negotiation process, and write advice for actors on how model-based knowledge can appropriately support their decision-making.

You need to:

- Use academic literature from this course with correct APA references
- Account for modelling choices driven by your actor's position (politics in knowledge production)
- Use notes and examples from the negotiation process to illustrate the roles of knowledge

Proposed outline (*you may deviate*)

Introduction

- The question you will answer
- Brief conceptualisation of roles knowledge can play in decision making (with references)
- How you analysed these roles in the negotiations (note-taking, grouping observations)

Systematic analysis Different roles of knowledge in the negotiations, with concrete examples and consequences for the overall decision-making process.

Recommendations Advice to actors participating in negotiations on how to use knowledge in different ways.

Length: Minimum 2,000 words, maximum 5,000 words.

Rubric — Part 2 (10 points total)

Criterion	Points	Description
Conceptualising roles of knowledge	1	Three or more distinct roles identified, drawing on course literature, specific to the policy context
Analysing roles of knowledge in negotiations	3	Specific analytical steps to systematically illustrate how knowledge was used; impact on decision making clearly described
Account of modelling choices and actor interests	2	Concrete description of choices made in the modelling process and why, linked to literature on roles of knowledge
Recommendations for better use of knowledge	2	Specific strategies linked to identified challenges, grounded in course literature and specific to the policy advice
Reflection on risks of proposed strategy	2	3+ risks addressed in detail, with justifications and potential adaptations

Submission

Submit via **Brightspace** by **19 June 2026, 17:00**:

1. Final report as PDF
2. Code repository link or ZIP file

Name your files: